MANDARIN ZEST
中文皮

TOCFL VOCABULARY LIST

# TOCFL Novice 2
# 234 words

準備級二級 · Before A1. Basic words for food, travel, school and home. Every word with pinyin, word type and meaning, plus a box to tick when you know it.

準二

| | |
|---|---|
| 234 | **new words**, by topic, as in the official list |
| 394 | **words in total** from Novice 1 up to this level |
| 繁 | **Traditional characters** and Taiwan pinyin, as used in the TOCFL |



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BEFORE YOU START

# How to use this list

1. **Read it out loud.** Say the pinyin with its tone every time, not just in your head.
2. **Learn a little every day.** 10 new words a day takes you through the whole list in about 3 weeks.
3. **Tick the box** once you can read the characters and give the meaning without looking.
4. **Cover a column to test yourself.** Hide the meaning, then the pinyin, then go from English back to Chinese.
5. **Review the unticked words** at the end of every week before adding new ones.

快樂 **kuàilè** adjective
Happy

Each entry shows the characters (Traditional), the pinyin, the word type and the meaning. When the official list gives several forms, like 這裡 / 這兒, they are all shown: any of them is correct.

## WHAT'S IN THE 234 WORDS




Word types follow the official TOCFL codes, grouped for readability: **adjective** = state verbs (Vs), **verb** = all other verbs (V, Vi, Vst, Vp…). Separable verbs keep their code (**V-sep**): they can split around an object, like 睡**個**覺.

## Jump to a topic


我 **Personal information** 個人資料 · 50 words
工 **Work** 工作 · 2 words
學 **Education** 教育 · 26 words
家 **Home and surroundings** 房屋與家庭、環境 · 25 words
日 **Daily life** 日常生活 · 8 words
玩 **Free time and fun** 閒暇時間、娛樂 · 15 words
友 **Relationships** 與他人的關係 · 4 words
車 **Travel and transport** 旅行 · 27 words
身 **Health and body** 健康及身體照護 · 16 words
買 **Shopping** 購物 · 17 words
吃 **Food and drink** 飲食 · 30 words
其 **Other useful words** 其他 · 14 words

## 01 我 Personal information 個人資料 · 50 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 1 | 男 | nán | noun | Male, man |
| ☐ | 2 | 女 | nǚ | noun | Female, woman |
| ☐ | 3 | 孩子 | háizi | noun | Child |
| ☐ | 4 | 小姐 | xiǎojiě | noun | Miss, young lady |
| ☐ | 5 | 先生 | xiānshēng | noun | Mr., gentleman, husband |
| ☐ | 6 | 太太 | tàitai | noun | Mrs., wife |
| ☐ | 7 | 女兒 | nǚér | noun | Daughter |
| ☐ | 8 | 兒子 | érzi | noun | Son |
| ☐ | 9 | 大家 | dàjiā | noun | Everyone |
| ☐ | 10 | 路 | lù | noun | Road, path |
| ☐ | 11 | 手機 | shǒujī | noun | Mobile phone |
| ☐ | 12 | 明年 | míngnián | noun | Next year |
| ☐ | 13 | 去年 | qùnián | noun | Last year |
| ☐ | 14 | 生日 | shēngrì | noun | Birthday |
| ☐ | 15 | 月 | yuè | noun | Month |
| ☐ | 16 | 日 | rì | noun | Day, date |
| ☐ | 17 | 星期 | xīngqí | noun | Week |
| ☐ | 18 | 星期天 / 星期日 | xīngqítiān / xīngqírì | noun | Sunday |
| ☐ | 19 | 禮拜天 | lǐbàitiān | noun | Sunday (casual) |
| ☐ | 20 | 週末 / 周末 | zhōumò | noun | Weekend |
| ☐ | 21 | 號 | hào | measure word | Day of the month / number |
| ☐ | 22 | 天 | tiān | noun measure word | Day / sky |
| ☐ | 23 | 從 | cóng | preposition | From |
| ☐ | 24 | 在 | zài | preposition verb | At, in / to exist |
| ☐ | 25 | 愛 | ài | verb | To love |
| ☐ | 26 | 快樂 | kuàilè | adjective | Happy |
| ☐ | 27 | 太 | tài | adverb | Too, excessively |
| ☐ | 28 | 公園 | gōngyuán | noun | Park |
| ☐ | 29 | 國家 | guójiā | noun | Country, nation |
| ☐ | 30 | 分鐘 | fēnzhōng | measure word | Minute (duration) |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 31 | 家人 | jiārén | noun | Family members |
| ☐ | 32 | 胖 | pàng | adjective | Fat, chubby |
| ☐ | 33 | 矮 | ǎi | adjective | Short (height) |
| ☐ | 34 | 瘦 | shòu | adjective | Thin, slim |
| ☐ | 35 | 萬 | wàn | noun | Ten thousand |
| ☐ | 36 | 鐘頭 | zhōngtóu | noun | Hour (duration) |
| ☐ | 37 | 晚 | wǎn | noun | Late / evening |
| ☐ | 38 | 前天 | qiántiān | noun | Day before yesterday |
| ☐ | 39 | 後天 | hòutiān | noun | Day after tomorrow |
| ☐ | 40 | 前年 | qiánnián | noun | Year before last |
| ☐ | 41 | 後年 | hòunián | noun | Year after next |
| ☐ | 42 | 自己 | zìjǐ | noun | Oneself, self |
| ☐ | 43 | 它 | tā | noun | It (non-human) |
| ☐ | 44 | 它們 | tāmen | noun | They (non-human) |
| ☐ | 45 | 最 | zuì | adverb | Most (superlative) |
| ☐ | 46 | 怕 | pà | verb | To fear, be afraid |
| ☐ | 47 | 美 | měi | adjective | Beautiful |
| ☐ | 48 | 應該 / 應 | yīnggāi / yīng | auxiliary Vaux | Should, ought to |
| ☐ | 49 | 真的 | zhēnde | adverb | Really, truly |
| ☐ | 50 | 非常 | fēicháng | adverb | Very, extremely |

## 02 工 Work 工作 · 2 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 51 | 工作 | gōngzuò | noun | Work, job |
| ☐ | 52 | 醫生 / 醫師 | yīshēng / yīshī | noun | Doctor |

## 03 學 Education 教育 · 26 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 53 | 一點 / 一點兒 / 一點點 | yīdiǎn / yīdiǎnr / yīdiǎndiǎn | determiner | A little bit |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 54 | 一些 | yīxiē | determiner | Some, a few |
| ☐ | 55 | 本 | běn | measure word | MW for books |
| ☐ | 56 | 張 | zhāng | measure word | MW for flat objects |
| ☐ | 57 | 英文 | yīngwén | noun | English language |
| ☐ | 58 | 紙 | zhǐ | noun | Paper |
| ☐ | 59 | 問題 | wèntí | noun | Question, problem |
| ☐ | 60 | 意思 | yìsi | noun | Meaning |
| ☐ | 61 | 餐廳 / 飯館 | cāntīng / fànguǎn | noun | Restaurant |
| ☐ | 62 | 畫 / 畫兒 | huà / huàr | verb noun | To draw / painting |
| ☐ | 63 | 讀 | dú | verb | To read, to study |
| ☐ | 64 | 會 | huì | auxiliary Vaux | Can, know how to / will |
| ☐ | 65 | 為什麼 | wèishénme | adjective | Why |
| ☐ | 66 | 下課 | xiàkè | verb V-sep | To finish class |
| ☐ | 67 | 說話 | shuōhuà | verb V-sep | To speak, to talk |
| ☐ | 68 | 考試 | kǎoshì | verb V-sep noun | To take an exam / test |
| ☐ | 69 | 懂 | dǒng | verb | To understand |
| ☐ | 70 | 念 / 唸 | niàn | verb | To read aloud, to study |
| ☐ | 71 | 課 | kè | noun | Class, lesson |
| ☐ | 72 | 教 | jiāo | verb | To teach |
| ☐ | 73 | 告訴 | gàosù | verb | To tell, inform |
| ☐ | 74 | 錯 | cuò | verb | Wrong, mistake |
| ☐ | 75 | 功課 | gōngkè | noun | Homework |
| ☐ | 76 | 教室 | jiàoshì | noun | Classroom |
| ☐ | 77 | 句子 | jùzi | noun | Sentence |
| ☐ | 78 | 休息 | xiūxí | verb | To rest |

## 04 家 Home and surroundings 房屋與家庭、環境 · 25 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 79 | 房(子) | fáng(zi) | noun | House, building |
| ☐ | 80 | 房間 | fángjiān | noun | Room |
| ☐ | 81 | 樓 | lóu | measure word | Floor, story |
| ☐ | 82 | 門 | mén | noun | Door |
| ☐ | 83 | 門口 | ménkǒu | noun | Entrance, doorway |
| ☐ | 84 | 桌(子) | zhuō(zi) | noun | Table, desk |
| ☐ | 85 | 椅(子) | yǐ(zi) | noun | Chair |
| ☐ | 86 | 床 | chuáng | noun | Bed |
| ☐ | 87 | 開 | kāi | verb | To open, to start |
| ☐ | 88 | 低 | dī | adjective | Low |
| ☐ | 89 | 不錯 | bùcuò | adjective | Not bad, quite good |
| ☐ | 90 | 天氣 | tiānqì | noun | Weather |
| ☐ | 91 | 空氣 | kōngqì | noun | Air |
| ☐ | 92 | 冷 | lěng | adjective | Cold |
| ☐ | 93 | 熱 | rè | adjective | Hot |
| ☐ | 94 | 雨 | yǔ | noun | Rain |
| ☐ | 95 | 下雨 | xiàyǔ | verb V-sep | To rain |
| ☐ | 96 | 風 | fēng | noun | Wind |
| ☐ | 97 | 山 | shān | noun | Mountain, hill |
| ☐ | 98 | 花 / 花兒 | huā / huār | noun | Flower |
| ☐ | 99 | 枝 | zhī | measure word | MW for pens/long objects |
| ☐ | 100 | 魚 | yú | noun | Fish |
| ☐ | 101 | 雞 | jī | noun | Chicken |
| ☐ | 102 | 牛 | niú | noun | Cow, cattle |
| ☐ | 103 | 豬 | zhū | noun | Pig, pork |

## 05 日 Daily life 日常生活 · 8 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 104 | 咖啡 | kāfēi | noun | Coffee |
| ☐ | 105 | 茶 | chá | noun | Tea |
| ☐ | 106 | 用 | yòng | verb | To use |
| ☐ | 107 | 穿 | chuān | verb | To wear (clothes) |
| ☐ | 108 | 起床 | qǐchuáng | verb | To get out of bed |
| ☐ | 109 | 方便 | fāngbiàn | adjective | Convenient |
| ☐ | 110 | 睡覺 | shuìjiào | verb V-sep | To sleep |
| ☐ | 111 | 起來 | qǐlái | verb | To get up, to rise |

## 06 玩 Free time and fun 閒暇時間、娛樂 · 15 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 112 | 先 | xiān | adverb | First, in advance |
| ☐ | 113 | 常常 / 常 | chángcháng / cháng | adverb | Often |
| ☐ | 114 | 每 | měi | determiner | Every, each |
| ☐ | 115 | 打 | dǎ | verb | To hit, to play (ball) |
| ☐ | 116 | 玩 | wán | verb | To play, have fun |
| ☐ | 117 | 運動 | yùndòng | verb noun | To exercise / Sports |
| ☐ | 118 | 走路 | zǒulù | verb V-sep | To walk |
| ☐ | 119 | 唱歌 | chànggē | verb V-sep | To sing |
| ☐ | 120 | 跳 | tiào | verb | To jump |
| ☐ | 121 | 還 | hái | adverb | Still, also, yet |
| ☐ | 122 | 唱 | chàng | verb | To sing |
| ☐ | 123 | 歌 | gē | noun | Song |
| ☐ | 124 | 跳舞 | tiàowǔ | verb V-sep | To dance |
| ☐ | 125 | 又 | yòu | adverb | And, again, both... and |
| ☐ | 126 | 球 | qiú | noun | Ball |

## 07 友 Relationships 與他人的關係 · 4 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 127 | 介紹 | jièshào | verb | To introduce |
| ☐ | 128 | 沒關係 | méiguānxi | adjective | No problem, it's okay |
| ☐ | 129 | 事 / 事兒 | shì / shìr | noun | Matter, thing, business |
| ☐ | 130 | 怎麼 | zěnme | adverb | How |

## 08 車 Travel and transport 旅行 · 27 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 131 | 哪 | nǎ | determiner | Which |
| ☐ | 132 | 裡面 / 裏面 | lǐmiàn | noun | Inside |
| ☐ | 133 | 上(面) | shàng(miàn) | noun | On top, above |
| ☐ | 134 | 下(面) | xià(miàn) | noun | Below, under |
| ☐ | 135 | 外(面) | wài(miàn) | noun | Outside |
| ☐ | 136 | 外頭 | wàitou | noun | Outside |
| ☐ | 137 | 前(面) | qián(miàn) | noun | In front |
| ☐ | 138 | 後(面) | hòu(miàn) | noun | Behind |
| ☐ | 139 | 左(邊) | zuǒ(biān) | noun | Left side |
| ☐ | 140 | 右(邊) | yòu(biān) | noun | Right side |
| ☐ | 141 | 旁(邊) | páng(biān) | noun | Beside, next to |
| ☐ | 142 | 裡 / 裏 | lǐ | noun | In, inside |
| ☐ | 143 | 中 | zhōng | noun | Middle, center |
| ☐ | 144 | 地方 | dìfāng | noun | Place, location |
| ☐ | 145 | 附近 | fùjìn | noun | Nearby, vicinity |
| ☐ | 146 | 帶 | dài | verb | To bring, carry |
| ☐ | 147 | 拿 | ná | verb | To take, hold |
| ☐ | 148 | 站 | zhàn | verb | To stand / station |
| ☐ | 149 | 快 | kuài | adjective | Fast, quick |
| ☐ | 150 | 慢 | màn | adjective | Slow |
| ☐ | 151 | 計程車 | jìchéngchē | noun | Taxi |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 152 | 火車 | huǒchē | noun | Train |
| ☐ | 153 | 飛機 | fēijī | noun | Airplane |
| ☐ | 154 | 輛 | liàng | measure word | MW for vehicles |
| ☐ | 155 | 出 | chū | verb | To go out, exit |
| ☐ | 156 | 進 | jìn | verb | To enter |
| ☐ | 157 | 外國 | wàiguó | noun | Foreign country |

## 09 身 Health and body 健康及身體照護 · 16 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 158 | 手 | shǒu | noun | Hand |
| ☐ | 159 | 腳 | jiǎo | noun | Foot |
| ☐ | 160 | 身體 | shēntǐ | noun | Body, health |
| ☐ | 161 | 眼睛 | yǎnjīng | noun | Eye |
| ☐ | 162 | 鼻(子) | bí(zi) | noun | Nose |
| ☐ | 163 | 藥 | yào | noun | Medicine |
| ☐ | 164 | 累 | lèi | adjective | Tired |
| ☐ | 165 | 頭 | tóu | noun | Head |
| ☐ | 166 | 耳朵 | ěrduo | noun | Ear |
| ☐ | 167 | 感冒 | gǎnmào | verb | To catch a cold |
| ☐ | 168 | 生病 | shēngbìng | verb Vp-sep | To get sick |
| ☐ | 169 | 餓 | è | adjective | Hungry |
| ☐ | 170 | 痛 | tòng | adjective | Painful, sore |
| ☐ | 171 | 嘴巴 / 嘴 | zuǐba / zuǐ | noun | Mouth |
| ☐ | 172 | 病 | bìng | noun | Illness |
| ☐ | 173 | 看病 | kànbìng | verb V-sep | To see a doctor |

## 10 買 Shopping 購物 · 17 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 174 | 元 | yuán | measure word | Currency unit / Dollar |
| ☐ | 175 | 鞋(子) | xié(zi) | noun | Shoe |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 176 | 衣服 / 衣 | yīfú / yī | noun | Clothing |
| ☐ | 177 | 比 | bǐ | preposition | To compare / than |
| ☐ | 178 | 要 | yào | verb · auxiliary Vaux | To want / will, must |
| ☐ | 179 | 長 | cháng | adjective | Long |
| ☐ | 180 | 新 | xīn | adjective | New |
| ☐ | 181 | 一樣 | yīyàng | adjective | Same, identical |
| ☐ | 182 | 見 | jiàn | verb | To see |
| ☐ | 183 | 看見 | kànjiɑn | verb | To see, catch sight of |
| ☐ | 184 | 聽見 | tīngjiàn | verb | To hear |
| ☐ | 185 | 店 | diàn | noun | Shop, store |
| ☐ | 186 | 短 | duǎn | adjective | Short (length) |
| ☐ | 187 | 飽 | bǎo | adjective | Full (not hungry) |
| ☐ | 188 | 舊 | jiù | adjective | Old (used, not new) |
| ☐ | 189 | 像 | xiàng | verb | To be like, resemble |
| ☐ | 190 | 一共 / 共 | yīgòng / gòng | adverb | Altogether, total |

## 11 吃 Food and drink 飲食 · 30 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 191 | 夠 | gòu | adjective | Enough |
| ☐ | 192 | 筷(子) | kuài(zi) | noun | Chopsticks |
| ☐ | 193 | 件 | jiàn | measure word | MW for clothing |
| ☐ | 194 | 杯 | bēi | measure word | MW for cups/glasses |
| ☐ | 195 | 杯(子) | bēi(zi) | noun | Cup, glass |
| ☐ | 196 | 菜 | cài | noun | Dish, vegetable, cuisine |
| ☐ | 197 | 肉 | ròu | noun | Meat |
| ☐ | 198 | 酒 | jiǔ | noun | Alcohol, wine |
| ☐ | 199 | 喝 | hē | verb | To drink |
| ☐ | 200 | 少 | shǎo | adjective | Few, little |
| ☐ | 201 | 多 | duō | adjective · adverb | Many, much; more |
| ☐ | 202 | 小吃 | xiǎochī | noun | Snack, street food |
| ☐ | 203 | 牛奶 | niúnǎi | noun | Milk |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 204 | 蛋 | dàn | noun | Egg |
| ☐ | 205 | 餃(子) | jiǎo(zi) | noun | Dumpling |
| ☐ | 206 | 麵 | miàn | noun | Noodles |
| ☐ | 207 | 湯 | tāng | noun | Soup |
| ☐ | 208 | 包子 | bāozi | noun | Steamed bun |
| ☐ | 209 | 蛋糕 | dàngāo | noun | Cake |
| ☐ | 210 | 麵包 | miànbāo | noun | Bread |
| ☐ | 211 | 水果 | shuǐguǒ | noun | Fruit |
| ☐ | 212 | 香蕉 | xiāngjiāo | noun | Banana |
| ☐ | 213 | 食物 | shíwù | noun | Food |
| ☐ | 214 | 飲料 | yǐnliào | noun | Drink, beverage |
| ☐ | 215 | 果汁 | guǒzhī | noun | Fruit juice |
| ☐ | 216 | 甜 | tián | adjective | Sweet |
| ☐ | 217 | 菜單 | càidān | noun | Menu |
| ☐ | 218 | 巧克力 | qiǎokèlì | noun | Chocolate |
| ☐ | 219 | 碗 | wǎn | noun measure word | Bowl |
| ☐ | 220 | 冰 | bīng | noun | Ice, iced |

## 12 其 Other useful words 其他 · 14 words

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 221 | 一起 | yīqǐ | adverb | Together |
| ☐ | 222 | 因為 | yīnwèi | conjunction | Because |
| ☐ | 223 | 和 | hé | conjunction | And |
| ☐ | 224 | 所以 | suǒyǐ | conjunction | So, therefore |
| ☐ | 225 | 跟 | gēn | conjunction | And, with |
| ☐ | 226 | 一定 | yīdìng | adverb | Definitely, certainly |
| ☐ | 227 | 可能 | kěnéng | auxiliary Vaux | Possible, may |
| ☐ | 228 | 邊 / 邊兒 | biān / biānr | noun | Side, edge |
| ☐ | 229 | 別 | bié | adverb | Don't / other |
| ☐ | 230 | 馬上 | mǎshàng | adverb | Immediately |

| ✓ | # | WORD | PINYIN | TYPE | MEANING |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 231 | 然後 | ránhòu | adverb | Then, afterwards |
| ☐ | 232 | 得 | děi | verb | Must, have to |
| ☐ | 233 | 著 | zhe | particle | Continuous aspect particle |
| ☐ | 234 | 有點 / 有一點 / 有一點兒 | yǒudiǎn / yǒuyīdiǎn / yǒuyīdiǎnr | adverb | A little, somewhat |

QUICK REFERENCE

# Measure words at a glance

Measure words (量詞) go between a number or 這/那 and a noun: 一本書, 這個人. Here are all the measure words in this level.

**號**
**hào**
Day of the month / number

**天**
**tiān**
Day / sky

**分鐘**
**fēnzhōng**
Minute (duration)

**本**
**běn**
MW for books

**張**
**zhāng**
MW for flat objects

**樓**
**lóu**
Floor, story

**枝**
**zhī**
MW for pens/long objects

**輛**
**liàng**
MW for vehicles

**元**
**yuán**
Currency unit / Dollar

**件**
**jiàn**
MW for clothing

**杯**
**bēi**
MW for cups/glasses

**碗**
**wǎn**
Bowl

NEXT STEP

# Use these 234 words in real conversations

A word list is a great checklist. The fastest way to make the words stick is to use them out loud with other people.

SPEAKING PRACTICE

## The Mandarin Zest Club

20+ live speaking sessions a month, hosted by a native teacher and advanced learners, so you can practise these words in real conversations.

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加油！